Zeporah Workflow 4: Caregiver Overwhelm, Compassionate Pause, and Human-Support Escalation

Version: 1.0 — Fully integrated product, operational, and handoff specification
Primary release context: Hospice and palliative-care pilot
Reusable contexts: Hospital discharge, home health, skilled nursing, assisted living, memory care, senior living, insurer member support, employer/EAP support
Primary user: Family Coordinator, Co-Coordinator, Family Helper, or another authorized family-space user
Supporting users: Approved Partner Support Team; Zeporah Support where authorized
Prerequisites: Workflow 1 — Family Onboarding, Consent, Roles, Permissions, and Visual Trust System; Workflow 2 — Serious Illness and Hospice-Care Preparation; Workflow 3 — Family Coordination, Communication, Tasks, and Documents

1. Workflow purpose

1.1 Family problem

A person caring for a loved one or handling family responsibilities after a serious diagnosis, hospice enrollment, care transition, or death may stop in the middle of a task because they are exhausted, grieving, frightened, interrupted, unsure what to do, worried about money or work, dealing with family conflict, or simply unable to process one more decision.

A standard digital product often treats inactivity as abandonment, pushes reminders, or responds with a generic resource list. That is unsafe and emotionally tone-deaf in a serious-illness or bereavement setting.

Workflow 4 gives Zeporah a compassionate, privacy-protecting response when a user cannot continue or actively asks for help. It preserves the user's progress, makes the next step smaller, offers delegation and support options, and provides a clear, explicit-consent path to request contact from hospice, social work, chaplaincy, bereavement support, an EAP, or another approved resource.

1.2 Family value

A user should leave this workflow feeling:

- "I am not failing because I cannot do this right now."
- "My progress is saved, and I can come back later."
- "I have choices: make this smaller, ask someone I trust, find support, or pause."
- "No one will be contacted or told about my private situation unless I choose it."

- “If I ask for help, I know exactly what information will be shared.”
- “Zeporah knows this is difficult without pretending to replace human care.”

1.3 Institutional value

For hospice, palliative-care programs, hospitals, senior-living communities, insurers, employers, and EAPs, Workflow 4 can:

- Create a voluntary, structured route for families to ask for appropriate human support.
- Improve routing quality by capturing user-selected request category, contact preference, and preferred time before the request reaches staff.
- Reduce the chance that a family gives up because a task is too large or they do not know whom to contact.
- Give staff clearer, consented requests without granting them access to private family workspace content.
- Provide measurable family-support engagement and response-time data, without treating emotional vulnerability as a source of leads or surveillance.

1.4 Scope

This workflow includes:

- Explicit user-initiated “I need help,” “I am overwhelmed,” “Not now,” “This task is too large,” “I cannot do this,” and related pathways.
- Nonintrusive return and repeated-incomplete-task support prompts.
- Draft preservation, smaller-step creation, delegation, task pausing, and task hiding.
- Needs-based support categories.
- Resource recommendation presentation with transparent source and cost information where verified.
- Consent-based request for human contact or a warm handoff.
- Urgent-help and emergency boundary messaging.
- Partner intake queue, acknowledgment status, follow-up limitations, and escalation rules.
- Privacy, notification, audit, data-minimization, and support-quality measures.
- Integration with care preparation, family coordination, post-death support, and first-year navigation.

1.5 Out of scope

Workflow 4 does not:

- Diagnose mental-health conditions, assess suicide risk, diagnose caregiver burnout, interpret symptoms, or provide therapeutic, medical, legal, financial, insurance, or emergency advice.

- Monitor user behavior as a clinical signal or automatically notify a partner, family member, emergency service, or resource based on a pause, emotion, or incomplete task.
- Promise a live response, emergency response, clinical triage, counseling appointment, resource availability, or partner service level without verified configuration.
- Provide crisis counseling or replace local emergency services, hospice triage, a mental-health crisis line, physician guidance, licensed therapy, legal counsel, or financial advice.
- Use support requests, browsing history, pauses, or emotional disclosures for paid referrals, lead sales, targeted advertising, ranking, or sponsorship influence.

2. Participants and responsibilities

Participant	Role in Workflow 4	Default authority
Family Coordinator	Chooses whether to pause, delegate, seek support, and approve external contact requests for the family workspace.	Full authority for external requests unless a task-specific exception is explicitly configured
Co-Coordinator	May use support tools for their own work and may draft/submit a request if authorized by Coordinator permissions.	Configurable; external request authority off by default
Family Helper	May pause task, request help from Coordinator, say task is too large, and access permitted support resources.	Cannot send external request on behalf of family by default
Family Viewer	May access support information shared with them and can request a private conversation with Coordinator if allowed.	No access to family task details or external-request authority by default
Partner Support Team	Receives only consented request fields and follows its own professional/operational workflow.	No default access to user emotional state, drafts, or workspace content
Zeporah System	Saves progress, shows user-controlled choices, matches support resources to stated needs/preferences, records consent, and routes approved requests.	No diagnosis, risk determination, or independent outreach authority
Zeporah Support	Provides platform/account support if separately requested or permitted.	Cannot access family content or make partner referral without authorized process

3. Core design principles

3.1 A pause is not failure

A user who pauses, skips, or returns later must never be described as late, noncompliant, incomplete, or failing. Zeporah recognizes that caregiving and grief are unpredictable.

3.2 User intent comes before system inference

The strongest triggers are explicit choices: “I need help,” “I feel overwhelmed,” “I cannot do this,” or “I do not have anyone to ask.” System-detected patterns may offer an unobtrusive option, but must never create a partner notification or infer a medical/mental-health condition.

3.3 Human support is opt-in

Zeporah may offer support. It must not contact a hospice, social worker, chaplain, insurer, EAP, family member, or external resource unless the authorized user sees the recipient, reviews exact fields to be shared, and explicitly sends the request.

3.4 Make the task smaller before making the person disclose more

The first useful response to overwhelm is often practical: save the draft, divide a task, postpone it, delegate one piece, or remove a deadline. The app should not force a user to explain feelings before offering these choices.

3.5 Do not turn vulnerability into a marketplace

Recommendations must be need-led, transparent, and family-controlled. Paid placement, referral fees, lead-selling, undisclosed sponsorship, or automatic provider outreach are prohibited.

3.6 Emergency boundaries are clear and immediate

Zeporah provides direct, visible instructions to contact local emergency services or the responsible hospice/care team when appropriate. It never implies that it monitors emergencies or can provide emergency intervention.

4. Entry conditions and triggers

4.1 Explicit user triggers

- User selects “I need help.”
- User selects “I feel overwhelmed.”
- User selects “Not now” and chooses “I need support before I return.”
- User marks “This task feels too large.”
- User selects “I cannot do this” on assigned task.
- User selects “I do not have anyone to ask.”
- User chooses “Find support.”
- User uses an available support-intent option such as “I need someone to talk to,” “I need a break,” “I need help with practical things,” or “I do not know who to call.”

4.2 Nonintrusive contextual triggers

These triggers may show a support option inside the private family space, but never cause an automatic message, referral, partner alert, or family notification.

- User returns after saving an incomplete emotionally significant task.
- User opens and exits the same optional task three times within 14 days.

- User repeatedly leaves a task unassigned after selecting “Ask someone to help.”
- User chooses a support need in Workflow 1, 2, 3, 5, or 6.
- User approaches a user-set task date and has not acted, if reminders are enabled.

4.3 Prohibited triggers

Do not trigger partner contact, provider referral, or family notification because a user:

- Pauses on a screen.
- Reads or edits a private note.
- Opens a document.
- Uses certain words in private free-text content, unless the person explicitly uses an available “urgent help” action or content is submitted within a configured direct-support request form.
- Appears distressed based on inferred behavior.
- Has a clinical diagnosis, demographic characteristic, location, financial status, or partner relationship.

4.4 Role-specific entry behavior

Role	May enter Workflow 4 from	External request authority
Family Coordinator	Any workflow, dashboard, task, support card, or direct action	Yes, with consent preview
Co-Coordinator	Any permitted item, task, or support card	Only if Coordinator granted external-request authority; otherwise drafts request for Coordinator approval
Family Helper	Assigned task, update, support card, or direct “need help” action	Requests Coordinator help; external request requires Coordinator approval by default
Family Viewer	Shared support information or private-question path	No external request by default; may request Coordinator contact if permitted

5. Workflow overview

```
User encounters a difficult task, pause, or support need
        ↓
User chooses “Not now,” “I need help,” “This feels too large,” or similar option
        ↓
Zeporah saves progress and offers practical choices
        ↓
Make task smaller / delegate / pause / hide / find support
        ↓
If user chooses support: show a few transparent resource options
        ↓
User may save, hide, contact independently, or request a connection
        ↓
For a connection: review recipient and exact data shared
```

```
        ↓
User explicitly sends request
        ↓
Partner receives only approved request fields and returns limited status
        ↓
User returns to preserved task or a calm next step
```

The user never has to complete a support assessment to save their work, leave, or make a task smaller.

6. Screen-by-screen workflow

Screen 1: Compassionate pause menu

Trigger

User selects “Not now,” “I need help,” “I feel overwhelmed,” “This task is too large,” or equivalent action within any supported workflow.

Goal

Acknowledge difficulty, save work, and offer choices without forcing disclosure.

User-facing content

Title: “You can pause here”

Body: “This is a lot to carry. You do not need to finish everything today. Your progress is saved.”

Actions

- “Show me one smaller step.”
- “Ask someone I trust to help.”
- “See support options.”
- “Save and come back later.”
- “Hide this for now.”
- “I need urgent help.”

System behavior

- Current draft is preserved before menu appears.
- No action requires explanation.
- “Hide this for now” removes nonurgent card from immediate dashboard for user-selected period: 24 hours, one week, one month, or until I bring it back.
- Hidden task remains private and recoverable from “Later” or search; it is not deleted.

- No support request, partner notification, or family message is sent from this screen.

Screen 2: Show one smaller step

Trigger

User selects “Show me one smaller step” or “This task feels too large.”

Goal

Transform an overwhelming action into a manageable, user-controlled next step.

User-facing content

Title: “Let’s make this smaller”

Body: “Choose one small thing that feels possible. You can stop after that.”

System logic

If original item is a task, show up to three relevant actions:

- “Write down what you need.”
- “Choose one person who might help.”
- “Set this aside until [user-selected time].”
- “Make one call or save one question.”
- “Break this into smaller steps.”

If original item is document/readiness task:

- “Find out where the document might be.”
- “Ask one person if they know.”
- “Write a question for the right professional.”
- “Mark this for later.”

If original item is family update/communication:

- “Write one sentence.”
- “Choose one person to update.”
- “Save a draft without sending.”

If original item is a care-plan question:

- “Save the question for later.”
- “Choose whether it is for the next call or visit.”
- “Ask Zeporah to help you find the right contact.”

Actions

- “Choose this step.”
- “Show different options.”
- “Break task into smaller steps.”
- “Save and return later.”

System behavior

- Smaller step inherits original privacy settings unless user changes it.
- Completing smaller step does not automatically mark original larger task complete.
- System displays gentle progress: “One step is enough for now.”

Screen 3: Ask someone I trust to help

Trigger

User selects delegation from pause menu, task detail, or support path.

Goal

Provide a low-pressure way to ask for help without sharing broad workspace access.

User-facing content

Title: “You do not have to do this alone”

Body: “You can ask someone to help with one specific thing. You decide what they can see.”

Options

- “Choose someone already in my family space.”
- “Invite someone for this one task.”
- “Write a private request I can send myself.”
- “I do not have anyone to ask.”
- “Back.”

Existing-person flow

- Show people with current role and access.
- User chooses task-only/view/complete/update permissions.
- If related document/contact is required, show separate share choice.
- Show assignment preview.

- Send task or save draft.

New-person flow

- Uses Workflow 1 invitation system with task-only Family Helper scope.
- Invitation includes no additional family/workspace content by default.
- User sees exact invitation content and access before sending.

Private-request template

User may copy/edit a message for a personal text/email outside Zeporah:

“Hi [Name], I am managing a lot right now. Would you be able to help with [task] by [timing]? It is okay if you cannot.”

System does not send personal message through external channels without user instruction and applicable product capability.

No-one-to-ask branch

Moves to Screen 5: support options. No partner notified automatically.

Screen 4: Save, hide, or return later

Trigger

User selects “Save and come back later,” “Hide this for now,” or leaves an incomplete nonurgent item.

Goal

Let the user create emotional space while preserving agency and work.

User-facing content

Title: “Take the time you need”

Body: “Your work is saved. Choose when, if ever, you want Zeporah to bring this back to your attention.”

Choices

- “Do not remind me.”
- “Ask me tomorrow.”
- “Ask me next week.”
- “Ask me in a month.”

- “I will bring it back myself.”

System behavior

- User can revise reminder later.
- Reminder is quiet-hours aware and uses nonjudgmental wording.
- Default after explicit hide: “I will bring it back myself.”
- No partner or family member sees that the user paused/hid an item unless user separately shares it.

Screen 5: Support options

Trigger

User chooses “See support options,” “I do not have anyone to ask,” selects a stated support need, or follows a relevant recommendation card.

Goal

Offer a small, relevant set of transparent options without pressuring the family into a referral.

User-facing content

Title: “Support that may help right now”

Body: “Based on what you selected, here are a few options. You can save them, contact them yourself, hide them, or ask Zeporah to request a connection. Nothing is shared unless you choose to send a request.”

Need selection if needed

If no support category is known, ask optional single-choice question:

“What kind of support would feel most helpful?”

- “Help with caregiving or practical responsibilities.”
- “Someone from the care team.”
- “A social worker or help finding resources.”
- “Faith, spiritual, or chaplain support.”
- “Emotional or grief support.”
- “Work, leave, money, or responsibilities at home.”
- “I am not sure.”

Resource card content

Each resource card includes:

- Resource name.
- Support category.
- What it can help with.
- “Why am I seeing this?” explanation.
- Relationship label: Your hospice team / organization-approved resource / public resource / nonprofit / local provider / virtual option.
- Cost status where verified: free, low-cost, sliding scale, insurance-covered where verified, employer-provided, paid, unknown.
- Verified language/accessibility/faith or cultural options where applicable.
- Actions: “Save,” “Hide,” “Contact independently,” “Request connection.”

System behavior

- Show a maximum of four cards initially.
- Never rank or insert cards based on paid placement, referral fees, lead sale, sponsorship, or commercial influence.
- “Why am I seeing this?” states the user-selected reason or stage, not an inference: “You selected practical caregiving help.”
- “Contact independently” opens contact details or secure link without sharing user data.
- “Hide” hides the resource and optionally asks why; answer optional and private.
- “Request connection” opens Screen 6.

Screen 6: Request a human connection

Trigger

Authorized user selects “Request connection” from a support card or direct support action.

Goal

Obtain clear, informed, specific consent before sharing anything with a partner or resource.

User-facing content

Title: “Request a connection”

Body: “Zeporah can send a request to [recipient]. You decide what to share. Private notes, documents, family messages, tasks, and anything you do not choose will not be included.”

Required fields

- Request type:
  - Speak with care team.
  - Speak with social worker.
  - Speak with chaplain or spiritual-care provider.
  - Request practical caregiver support.
  - Request volunteer or respite support.
  - Request caregiver or bereavement support.
  - Request work, leave, or EAP support.
  - Help understanding who to contact.
  - Other.
- Preferred contact method.
- Preferred contact time.

Optional fields

- Short user-written message.
- Permission to leave voicemail/message.
- Preferred language, if user wants it used for this request.
- Optional broad support category, not a task title/details by default.

Role-specific behavior

- Coordinator can submit.
- Co-Coordinator can submit only if granted request authority; otherwise “Send to Coordinator for approval” is primary action.
- Helper can draft request and send to Coordinator for approval; no external transmission by default.
- Viewer can request Coordinator support contact if configured; no partner transmission.

Share preview

Will be shared

- Requestor/Coordinator name, as applicable.
- Preferred contact method/time.
- Selected request category.
- Preferred language if selected.
- Optional user-written message.

- Optional broad support category if selected.

Will not be shared

- Private notes.
- Documents.
- Family Updates.
- Task titles, details, or status unless separately selected in a later dedicated flow.
- Contact directory.
- Other family member names and roles.
- Private messages or conflict information.
- Recommendation history.
- Anything user did not select.

Actions

- “Send my request.”
- “Send to Coordinator for approval,” where applicable.
- “Save draft.”
- “Cancel.”

Consent acknowledgment

“I understand Zeporah will send the information listed above to [recipient].”

System behavior after send

- Generate request ID and consent record.
- Send only approved fields to configured partner/resource queue.
- Show confirmation: “Your request was sent. If the service offers status updates, we will show them here.”
- Do not guarantee response time unless configured service level is explicitly displayed.
- User may withdraw unacknowledged request where technically and operationally possible; withdrawal cannot undo information already received.

Screen 7: Request awaiting response or status update

Trigger

User opens submitted request or receives allowed status update.

User-facing content

Title: “Your support request”

Statuses:

- “Your request was received.”
- “A team member has been notified.”
- “A team member attempted to contact you.”
- “You were connected with support.”
- “This request is complete.”
- “This service may not be available. Here are other options.”

Actions

- “Review what I shared.”
- “Update contact preference,” if request is not yet acted on.
- “Withdraw request,” if available.
- “See other support options.”
- “Return to my task.”

System behavior

- Show only plain status; do not show partner staff notes, clinical records, internal queue data, or third-party information.
- If partner fails to acknowledge within configured target, show neutral language and alternatives. Do not blame user or partner.
- If user withdraws, record event and notify partner only if operationally possible; show transparent result.

Screen 8: Urgent-help boundary

Trigger

User selects “I need urgent help” or an equivalent explicit urgent-help action.

Goal

Give clear immediate direction without pretending Zeporah is an emergency service.

User-facing content

Title: “Get urgent help now”

Primary message:

“If someone is in immediate danger or needs urgent medical help, call local emergency services now.”

Hospice-specific message, only if verified and configured:

“If your loved one is receiving hospice care, you can also contact the hospice’s 24-hour line: [verified number].”

Product boundary:

“Zeporah cannot monitor emergencies, provide emergency response, or determine what level of medical care is needed.”

Actions

- “Call emergency services.”
- “Call hospice 24-hour line,” if available.
- “Return to Zeporah.”

System behavior

- Call actions use device dialer; no call recording or disclosure to partner through Zeporah.
- Do not start a partner request, family notification, or automated outreach from urgent-help screen.
- Record only an optional de-identified safety-screen display event for product quality; do not record or infer emergency details.

7. Support recommendation logic

7.1 Matching inputs

Recommendations may use only data necessary to help match an option:

- Explicitly selected support category.
- Current journey stage chosen by family.
- User-selected location or virtual preference.
- Preferred language.

- User-selected faith, spiritual, cultural, cost, or accessibility preferences.
- Partner connection status and current approved offerings.
- Resource availability/eligibility where verified.

7.2 Matching exclusions

Recommendations must not use:

- Inferred diagnosis, prognosis, mental-health condition, risk level, or emotional state.
- Private note/document contents.
- Passive browsing behavior.
- Financial information not explicitly volunteered for support navigation.
- Paid-placement or referral economics.
- Race, ethnicity, religion, disability, age, or other sensitive characteristics unless user voluntarily selected a preference that directly informs the type of resource requested.

7.3 Recommendation frequency controls

- No more than one nonessential support prompt per active user session unless user explicitly opens support.
- If user hides resource, suppress it for at least 90 days or until user restores it.
- If user selects “Not now” for support, suppress proactive support cards for 30 days, except user-initiated support entry and safety messaging.
- Do not repeat a recommendation already saved unless user opens saved resources.

8. Partner operational workflow

8.1 Pre-launch configuration

Every participating organization must configure:

- Program and service-line identity.
- Verified main, after-hours, and emergency-related contact guidance.
- Support request categories it accepts.
- Destination queue and accountable role for each category.
- Operating hours and displayed/contracted acknowledgment target, if any.
- After-hours behavior.
- Escalation owner for unacknowledged requests.
- Internal and external resource approval process.
- Language access and accessibility procedures.

- Data-sharing agreement, privacy notice, and retention policy.
- Process for request withdrawal, erroneous requests, and unavailable service.

8.2 Request routing matrix

Family-selected request	Default destination	Partner action
Speak with care team	Care-team or triage-support queue	Follow organization's clinical communication procedure; Zeporah does not triage
Social worker	Social-work queue	Provide psychosocial/practical navigation within professional scope
Chaplain/spiritual care	Spiritual-care queue	Contact according to preference/availability
Practical caregiver support	Social work, volunteer, care-navigation, or resource queue	Share available supports or arrange connection per policy
Volunteer/respite	Volunteer/resource coordination queue	Confirm availability and next steps; do not promise service until confirmed
Caregiver/bereavement support	Bereavement/social-work/support queue	Contact based on program policy and stage
Work, leave, or EAP	Employer/EAP/benefits support queue	Explain available pathway within service boundaries
Help understanding who to contact	Family support/customer-service navigation queue	Guide to appropriate internal route without workspace access

8.3 Partner queue fields

Only explicitly approved fields enter queue:

- Zeporah request identifier.
- Request category.
- Coordinator/requestor name where approved.
- Preferred contact method and time.
- Preferred language, if selected.
- Optional user-written message.
- Optional broad support category, if selected.
- Submission timestamp.
- Relevant organization/program identifier.

8.4 Partner cannot access

Partner never gets by default:

- The user's paused task or draft.
- Family workspace.

- Contacts, notes, documents, messages, questions, updates, or task list.
- Family member identities/roles.
- Family conflict details.
- Recommendation history.
- User's support-screen path or pause history.
- Inferred emotional condition, clinical data, or emergency indication.
- Any information not included in the reviewed consent preview.

8.5 Partner response statuses

- Received.
- Acknowledged.
- Contact attempted.
- Connected.
- Referred to another service.
- Closed—family declined or no longer needs support.
- Closed—unable to reach after configured attempts.
- Closed—service unavailable; alternatives offered where applicable.

8.6 Partner service-level safeguards

- Do not display a response-time promise unless partner commits to it and Zeporah can operationally monitor it.
- If target is missed, show family neutral status and other options; activate internal escalation owner per agreement.
- Staff may not use Zeporah support requests to market unrelated services or solicit referrals.
- Partner users must complete privacy/consent training before queue access.

9. Notifications and reminders

9.1 Principles

- User chooses notification channels and frequency.
- No sensitive personal, medical, grief, task, or support details in lock-screen/email/SMS previews.
- Respect quiet hours.
- Do not notify family members about user overwhelm, task hiding, support browsing, or an external support request unless the user explicitly shares it.

- Use nonjudgmental language.

9.2 Notification catalogue

Event	Recipient	Default notification	Conditions
Draft saved after pause	User	“Your progress is saved in Zeporah.”	In-app only by default
User-selected reminder	User	“When you are ready, one small next step is here.”	Only at selected time and consented channel
Task-help request to Coordinator	Coordinator	“A task may need your attention.”	No task detail in preview
Support request sent	Requestor/Coordinator	“Your support request was sent.”	Immediate, privacy-preserving
Support request acknowledged	Requestor/Coordinator	“Your support request was acknowledged.”	Partner status update
Contact attempted	Requestor/Coordinator	“A team member attempted to contact you.”	Partner status update
Request needs Coordinator approval	Coordinator	“A support request is ready for your review.”	Co-Coordinator/Helper draft only
Request withdrawn	Requestor/Coordinator	“Your support request was withdrawn.”	If successful/recorded
Service unavailable	Requestor/Coordinator	“This support option may not be available. Other options are available.”	Partner status or resource validation
Gentle return prompt	User	“When you are ready, Zeporah is here.”	At most once per selected interval

10. Privacy, data minimization, and audit rules

10.1 Minimum data for pause support

- Current screen/task identifier.
- Draft state where user has entered content.
- User-selected pause or support action.
- User-selected reminder preference.
- User-selected support category/preferences.
- Consent record only if a connection request is sent.

10.2 Data not collected or inferred

- Diagnosis of mental-health condition.
- Clinical risk score.
- Crisis status inferred from pause behavior.
- Detailed reason for not completing a task.
- Family conflict details unless user voluntarily places them in a submitted support-request message.
- Medical, legal, financial, insurance, or emergency conclusions.

10.3 Audit events

- compassionate_pause_opened
- draft_saved_after_pause
- task_hidden
- task_unhidden
- smaller_step_offered
- smaller_step_selected
- task_split_from_overwhelm
- delegation_path_opened
- trusted_help_request_drafted
- trusted_help_request_sent
- no_helper_selected
- support_need_selected
- support_recommendation_shown
- support_recommendation_saved
- support_recommendation_hidden
- support_connection_started
- support_connection_drafted
- support_connection_sent_to_coordinator
- support_connection_share_preview_viewed
- support_connection_consent_confirmed
- support_connection_sent
- support_connection_withdrawn
- partner_request_status_updated
- urgent_help_boundary_opened
- reminder_preference_set

- reminder_suppressed

Audit events record actor, timestamp, workspace, action, scope, and relevant consent/request reference. They do not replicate private draft text or other private content unnecessarily.

11. Decision and branching logic

11.1 User wants to pause but not disclose why

- Save draft.
- Offer reminder choice.
- Return to dashboard.
- No support category, partner notification, or family message required.

11.2 User wants help from family

- Offer existing person, task-only invite, private message template, or no-one-to-ask branch.
- Preserve user's task privacy settings.
- If related item requires sharing, show separate access review.

11.3 User has no one to ask

- Acknowledge: "It is okay if you do not have someone to ask right now."
- Offer support options, keep task private, smaller step, or return later.
- Do not repeatedly prompt family invitation.

11.4 User requests partner support

- Require recipient-specific request category, contact method/time, share preview, consent, and send action.
- Partner receives only approved fields.
- User retains support-request status in family space.

11.5 Helper wants external support

- Helper can use public/independent resources or request Coordinator support.
- External request defaults to Coordinator approval.
- System must explain: "The Family Coordinator will review this before Zeporah contacts anyone on behalf of the family."

11.6 User changes mind after request

- Before partner acknowledgment, allow withdrawal where supported.
- After transmission, explain withdrawal cannot erase received information but can stop further handling where policy permits.
- Do not automatically share reason for withdrawal.

11.7 Urgent help

- Explicit urgent action displays Screen 8.
- No automated external contact/monitoring.
- Return to Zeporah only after clear emergency options are visible.

11.8 User has hidden recommendation or opted out

- Do not show hidden resource for configured suppression period.
- Do not show nonessential proactive cards during opt-out period.
- Allow user to open Support manually at any time.

12. Exceptions and edge cases

- **No connectivity:** Save draft locally only where securely supported; label “Not sent”; never claim request sent until server confirmation.
- **Request submitted twice:** Detect duplicate within configured period; show existing request and ask whether to keep it, withdraw, or submit new request.
- **Partner queue unavailable:** Show “We cannot send this request right now.” Preserve draft; offer contact independently, retry later, or another resource.
- **Incorrect recipient selected:** Allow cancellation before send; after send, route withdrawal if possible and log correction.
- **Coordinator no longer active:** Helper/Co-Coordinator cannot bypass authority automatically; show formal transfer/support process from Workflow 1 and independent resource options.
- **Partner does not offer selected service:** Disclose unavailable status; show approved alternatives if available; do not route to unrelated commercial provider.
- **No local resources:** Offer virtual, public, national, or general navigation options only when verified/configured.
- **User prefers no contact:** Allow save/hide/contact independently; do not push request action.
- **Language/accessibility barrier:** Apply user preferences; display partner language availability accurately; offer alternate contact method when configured.
- **Family conflict:** Keep request/draft private to authorized scope; do not expose conflict to other family members or partner unless user explicitly includes it in the approved

message.

- **Minor user or unclear authority:** Follow age/guardian/authorization policy; no assumption of authority to request services for another person.
- **User writes highly sensitive credentials in optional message:** Display warning before send; allow edit; do not include data outside user-approved preview; apply security policy.

13. Metrics and acceptance criteria

13.1 Family experience measures

- Percentage of users who save/return rather than abandon an in-progress item.
- Smaller-step selection and completion rate.
- Task delegation rate after overwhelm path.
- Support-option view, save, hide, independent-contact, and connection-request rates.
- Time from request submission to partner acknowledgment where available.
- User-rated helpfulness of pause and support experience.
- User-reported sense of control, privacy understanding, and reduced burden.
- Rate of users who use “Not now” and later return.

13.2 Organization value measures

- Voluntary support-request volume by category.
- Request completeness rate.
- Partner acknowledgment and completion time.
- Rate of successful connection versus unavailable/referred requests.
- Family satisfaction with ease of obtaining help.
- Staff-reported appropriateness of routed requests.
- Repeat nonclinical support contacts where ethically/lawfully measurable.
- Resource relevance and no-show/decline patterns, interpreted cautiously.

13.3 Privacy and safety measures

- Share-preview completion rate.
- Requests sent with minimum necessary fields.
- Request withdrawal/correction rate.
- Unauthorized-access attempts.
- Support recommendation hide/opt-out rate.
- Emergency-boundary screen display rate, without content inference.
- Partner service-level exception rate.

- Audit-log completeness.

13.4 Acceptance criteria

Workflow 4 is ready for pilot only when:

1. Every supported workflow offers a clear, nonjudgmental pause path.
2. Current drafts save before a user leaves, where technically feasible.
3. Users can make a task smaller, delegate, hide, or return later without disclosing a personal reason.
4. Pauses, repeated incomplete tasks, and support needs never automatically notify family, partners, providers, or emergency services.
5. Support recommendations are based only on stated needs/preferences and transparent matching rules.
6. Recommendations are not influenced by paid placement, referral fees, sponsorship, or lead sales.
7. External support requests display recipient and exact fields shared; an authorized user must explicitly consent before send.
8. Helpers and Co-Coordinators cannot send external requests beyond their authorized scope.
9. Partner queues receive only consented minimum data and return only limited status.
10. Urgent-help screen clearly directs user to emergency services/responsible care team and states Zeporah's limitations.
11. No emergency monitoring, diagnosis, triage, or automated outreach is implied or implemented.
12. Notifications are privacy-preserving, quiet-hours aware, and optional.
13. Users can withdraw/correct requests within stated operational limits.
14. Workflow is mobile-accessible, plain-language, and usable for people under stress.
15. Pilot instrumentation measures family support, partner response, privacy, safety, and service-quality outcomes.

14. Workflow integration and handoffs

14.1 Integration purpose

Workflow 4 is the compassionate safety and support layer across the entire Zeporah journey. It is not a separate destination that requires a family to restart or repeat information. It can be entered from care preparation, family coordination, immediate post-death tasks, or first-year life administration whenever a user needs to pause, reduce burden, delegate, or ask for help.

The workflow preserves the user's place and returns them to the relevant task or a calm dashboard after they pause, seek support, or receive a status update. It uses the existing private workspace and current permissions; it never overrides them.

14.2 What enters Workflow 4

Entering object/context	Source	How Workflow 4 uses it
Workspace ID and authenticated user	Workflow 1 / shared platform	Associates pause/support action with correct private space and validates current role
Roles and permissions	Workflow 1; current changes across system	Determines ability to delegate, draft, approve, or send external request
Current draft, task, question, update, document/readiness item, or stage action	Workflow 2, 3, 5, or 6	Saves progress; offers smaller step/return path; does not expose content beyond existing scope
Privacy/access settings	Workflow 1 and item-level rules	Preserves item visibility through pause/delegation/support actions
Journey state	Shared journey state	Tailors family-facing wording and relevant support categories; does not infer prognosis/risk
User-selected needs/preferences	Workflows 1–6	Matches optional resources based on explicit selections only
Location/language/accessibility/cost/faith-spiritual preferences	Workflow 1 and user settings	Tailors relevant resource options when user chose to provide them
Existing family members and task roles	Workflow 1/3	Offers delegate options within existing access boundaries
Partner connection and request-path configuration	Workflow 1 / partner configuration	Shows only available voluntary support request options
Resource history	Shared recommendation service	Avoids hidden/declined/repetitive recommendations
Prior request/audit status	System layer	Shows user's own request status; does not authorize another disclosure

14.3 What Workflow 4 creates or updates

Object / setting	Created or updated	Default visibility	Controller
Pause state	Saved draft, pause timestamp, return context	User/private item scope	User; system preserves
Reminder preference	No reminder, tomorrow, week, month, self-return	User only	User
Hidden-item preference	Hide interval and restore option	User/private item scope	User/Coordinator where item shared
Smaller-step plan	User-selected microstep/subtask	Inherits original item scope	Original item controller / user within scope
Delegation draft	Proposed helper, task scope, optional related-item scope	Coordinator/private until sent	Coordinator or authorized user

Object / setting	Created or updated	Default visibility	Controller
Trusted-help request	Internal task request/invitation	Item-specific	Coordinator/authorized user
User-selected support need	Optional stated support category	User/Coordinator scope according to role	User; Coordinator controls external family request
Resource engagement	Saved, hidden, independent-contact, or requested-connection actions	Private to user/Coordinator context	User
External support-request draft	Recipient, category, preferred contact, optional message	Coordinator only by default	Coordinator/authorized role
External support-request consent	Recipient, exact fields, consent version/time, request ID	System audit; family sees summary	System-managed
Partner status update	Limited request status	Requestor/Coordinator only by default	Partner sends status; family sharing remains Coordinator-controlled
Urgent-help screen event	Product-quality event only	Not family/partner visible	System; no emergency-content inference

14.4 What Workflow 4 sends forward

Object/capability available later	Later workflow(s)	Conditions/use
Preserved drafts and return context	Origin workflow: 2, 3, 5, or 6	User returns to permitted unfinished item; no loss of privacy scope
Smaller steps/subtasks	Workflow 3 and origin workflow	Retain inherited permissions; can be assigned later
Delegated tasks and task status	Workflow 3; relevant origin workflow	Task-only scope persists; no broader access granted
User-set reminder/hide preferences	Workflows 2–6	Controls nonjudgmental resurfacing of item
Stated support needs and support preferences	Shared recommendation service across 2–6	Tailors optional offers; never auto-refers
Saved/hidden resource history	Shared recommendation service across 2–6	Prevents inappropriate repetition; remains private
Submitted external request summary/status	Workflows 2, 3, 5, 6	Family sees request status; partner sees only specific request
Updated role/approval action	Workflow 1 governance and Workflow 3 coordination	Applies only if Coordinator explicitly changes permissions/assignments
Audit/consent records	System layer	Supports security/compliance; does not authorize future request

14.5 What remains private or inactive

- A pause, hidden task, incomplete action, smaller-step selection, support-card view, or emotional-support preference does not notify a partner, family member, provider, or emergency service.
- Current draft/task/question/document remains subject to original item-level permissions and is not attached to an external request by default.
- A Helper's statement that a task is difficult or impossible remains private to Coordinator/authorized Co-Coordinator unless Helper chooses otherwise.
- Private family conflict information is not shared with other family members or a partner by inference.
- Resource browsing, saving, hiding, and independent contact do not create a lead, referral, payment event, sponsorship event, or partner notification.
- An external request does not give the recipient ongoing access to the workspace, later drafts, or later-created content.
- A previous external request consent never applies to a new recipient, category, or contact attempt.
- Urgent-help selection does not cause automatic emergency contact, partner alert, location sharing, or monitoring.

14.6 What triggers another workflow

Trigger in Workflow 4	Resulting workflow/capability	Required continuation behavior
User chooses smaller step/return to item	Origin Workflow 2, 3, 5, or 6	Return to preserved context with new smaller action if created
User delegates task or invites task-only helper	Workflow 3 coordination and Workflow 1 permission service	Show item scope/preview; grant only approved access
User selects care-team question/contact support	Workflow 2 or consented support request path	Offer appropriate question/contact action; never auto-send
User selects outside support / Request connection	Consent-based partner handoff service	Display exact recipient/data; require explicit approval
User changes journey stage to recent loss	Workflow 5	Preserve state, acknowledge change, no automatic notices
User selects later-life/estate/grief task after loss	Workflow 6	Return to chosen task with user preferences/permissions intact
Coordinator updates access to enable help	Workflow 1 governance service	Apply permission change only after Coordinator confirmation
Partner returns request status	Origin dashboard/Workflow 4 status view	Show plain-language status; no staff notes/clinical content

14.7 What the family sees

The family does not see “Workflow 4,” “escalation,” “risk,” “handoff,” or technical system labels. They see supportive, human language:

- “You can pause here.”
- “Let’s make this smaller.”
- “You do not have to do this alone.”
- “Take the time you need.”
- “Support that may help right now.”
- “Request a connection.”
- “Get urgent help now.”

After support actions, they return to a familiar family context:

- “Your progress is saved. You can continue when you are ready.”
- “One step is enough for now.”
- “That task has a new plan. You can return to it whenever you are ready.”
- “Your request was sent. While you wait, you can keep this private, choose another option, or return later.”

The product must avoid making the family feel observed, scored, escalated, or referred. It should feel like a private, optional set of choices inside their existing Zeporah family space.

14.8 What a partner sees

A partner sees only a specific, consented support request. It may receive request ID, selected category, authorized requestor/Coordinator name, preferred contact method/time, preferred language if selected, optional user message, optional broad support category if selected, submission time, and relevant program identifier.

A partner does not see pause history, reminder settings, hidden tasks, drafts, care-plan content, documents, contacts, family updates, task details/status, family identities/roles, conflict information, resource browsing history, emotional disclosures outside the approved request, urgent-help screen use, journey-stage history, notifications, or general audit logs.

A partner may return only limited request status: received, acknowledged, contact attempted, connected, referred, closed—no longer needed, closed—unable to reach, or closed—service unavailable. It does not return staff notes, clinical information, or internal operational details to the family space.

15. Handoff to other workflows

Handoff to Workflow 2: Serious Illness and Hospice-Care Preparation

Trigger: User returns to a care-plan question, contact, readiness item, comfort/preference entry, or care-team support need.

Information available: Preserved private draft/context; smaller-step plan; user-selected support preferences; selected care contact/request status under existing permissions.

Not automatically shared: Pause reason, emotional support selection, private notes/documents, family conflict details, or external request details beyond user's own status.

Family-facing continuation: "Your progress is saved. Would you like to take one small step with your care plan, or return later?"

Handoff to Workflow 3: Family Coordination, Communication, Tasks, and Documents

Trigger: User delegates, invites task-only helper, creates smaller subtask, asks family for help, or changes task visibility/access.

Information available: Task/subtask, current visibility, owner, status, related item only if separately approved, current role rules.

Not automatically shared: Full origin task context, private notes, documents, emotional state, or support request history.

Family-facing continuation: "You can share only this task. The person you choose will see only what you approve."

Handoff to Workflow 5: Immediate Post-Death Guidance and Funeral-Period Coordination

Trigger: Family Coordinator intentionally changes journey stage to recent loss while in a support/pause path, or opens immediate-loss support after a confirmed stage transition.

Information retained: Workspace roles; privacy defaults; drafts/tasks under existing scope; reminders; saved resources; support preferences; submitted-request status.

No automatic notifications: No partner, helper, care team, or resource notice merely because stage changes.

Family-facing continuation: "We are so sorry for your loss. You can pause whenever you need to. We can focus on what matters right now."

Handoff to Workflow 6: First-Year Bereavement, Estate, Benefits, and Life-Administration Navigation

Trigger: User enters later-loss support, estate/benefit task, anniversary support, or long-term caregiver/bereavement resource path.

Information retained: User preferences, workspace permissions, applicable tasks/reminders, saved/hidden resource history, and request status under existing scope. Historic consent never transfers to a new external request.

Family-facing continuation: “Choose one next step for today. If it feels like too much, you can pause or ask for support at any time.”